

working and help them understand the visual appearance of each of the game asset.

Creating clay models

Clay models are needed when 2D sketches of concept art are not sufficient to depict the geometry of the object/character. This process helps the 3D digital artist understand the concept better. These clay models are easily be scanned into popular 3D software for further detailing. One thing that clay models have superior to organic modeling programs is that you can make cuts clear through the surface. Products like Mudbox, etc. simply can't do that.

Creating blueprints

Understanding 3D concept art may be hard for digital artists due to constraints of perspective, detail etc. Often 3D artists want the concept art to be more detailed. This may include zoom-in parts of some pieces of art to know more detail, object from different perspectives such as side view, front view and behind view. Same as clay models, they can be imported directly into the 3D modeling software to allow the creation of the digital models. Blueprints are made from orthogonal drawings set in top, front and side views.

Tools used

- ▶ Pencil and paper for sketches
- ▶ Adobe Photoshop, GIMP etc for digital sketches
- ▶ Clay, Wax etc for physical 3D models



A blueprint of a character

Level design

Level design is the soul of a game. A player interacts with the game through levels. Level design is both an artistic and technical process. Once the game designer details the game design document in the pre-production, the level designers get accelerated in designing the levels of the game. Level design includes the planning and integration of various 3D objects that form the game level. Various objects that make up a game level such as buildings, rooms, vegetation etc are placed into their corresponding locations. The level designers may need art assets from the art team and some assistance from the programming team to implement level editor and other tools.